予 想 問 題　第 1 回

前 期 日 程　対 策

英 語 問 題

山形大学（人文社会科学部・医学部ほか 英語を課す学部の共通問題）の出題形式に準拠 ／ 問題

注　意

1. 問題部分と解答用紙で構成されている（問題部分 1〜6ページ・解答用紙 7〜8ページ）。答えは解答用紙の決められた欄に書くこと。
2. 試験時間の目安は90分。大問は Ⅰ・Ⅱ の2題で，英文は2本。設問の指示は英語で書かれている。
3. 日本語で答える設問（和訳・字数指定の説明）と，英語で答える設問（英作文など）がある。
4. 配点は Ⅰ 100点・Ⅱ 100点（計200点）。本予想問題が独自に定めた配点である。
5. 本冊子の英文・設問はすべてオリジナルである。登場する人物・団体・地名は架空。

山形大学の過去問・公式問題ではありません。予想問題であり，大学とは関係がありません。
本冊子は過去の出題形式を分析して作成した練習用の教材です。

I 長文読解（エッセイ）（配点 100点）

Go through the passage, then answer Q1 to Q5.

Recipes Without Numbers

① My grandmother kept her recipes in a tin box that had once held biscuits. There were perhaps sixty cards inside, each written in her small, sloping handwriting, and almost none of them contained a number. Her instructions for bread asked for “enough flour to make it behave”. Her apple cake was to be baked “until the kitchen smells right”. One card, for a soup I loved as a child, simply listed six vegetables and ended with the words “you will know”.

② When I was young, these cards drove me mad. I was the kind of child who liked rules, and I wanted to know exactly how many grams of flour went into the bowl and exactly how many minutes the cake should stay in the oven. Whenever I asked, my grandmother would laugh and say that the dough would tell me. I assumed she was simply being difficult, or that she had forgotten the real amounts and was too proud to admit it.

③ She died when I was twenty-three, and the tin box came to me. That winter, missing her, I decided to make her bread. I followed the card as closely as I could, which was not very closely at all, and the result was a flat, heavy loaf that even the birds in the garden seemed to avoid. I tried again the next weekend with more yeast* and a hotter oven. The second loaf was worse.

④ Eventually I telephoned my aunt Maura, who had spent much of her childhood in that kitchen. I expected her to give me the missing numbers. Instead she paused and then said, “Mum never measured. She watched.” She explained that my grandmother added flour a little at a time, pressing the dough with her fingers, until it stopped sticking to her hands but still felt soft. The amount changed from day to day, depending on the weather and the flour.

⑤ That conversation changed the way I read the cards. I had treated them as incomplete instructions, as if my grandmother had been careless. In fact, they were reminders written by someone who already knew how to cook, for someone who would learn by doing. The real recipe had never been on the cards; it had been in her hands. The words were only there to point the way.

⑥ So I began to cook every Sunday, slowly and with a great deal of failure. I kept a notebook beside the bowl and wrote down what I noticed: how the dough felt when it was too wet, how it looked when it had risen enough, how the smell of the cake changed in the last few minutes before it was done. Some weeks the notes were more useful than the bread.

⑦ Gradually, my hands started to recognise what my eyes had missed. I learned that a good dough springs back slowly when you press it, and that a cake is ready when it begins to pull

away from the sides of the tin. None of this was written on the cards, and I am not sure I could have learned it from a book. I had to get it wrong many times before I could get it right.

⑧ I do not want to pretend that numbers are useless. Modern recipes, with their precise weights and temperatures, make it possible for a beginner to produce something edible on the first attempt, and that is a real gift. When I cook a dish I have never tried before, I am grateful for them. But precise instructions can also encourage us to stop paying attention. If the recipe says twenty-five minutes, we set a timer and walk away, even if our oven runs hot or our pan is thinner than the writer's.

⑨ My grandmother's cards asked for something different. They assumed that the cook would stay in the kitchen, using all of her senses, and would answer for the result herself instead of blaming the instructions. That is a harder way to cook, but I have come to think it is also a more satisfying one.

⑩ These days I write my own cards. I include the numbers, because I want my niece, who is nine, to have somewhere to start. But under each set of measurements I add a line or two about what to look for: the colour of the onions, the hiss of the oil, the moment when the sauce coats the back of a spoon. I suspect she will find these lines as annoying as I once found her great-grandmother's.

⑪ That is fine. One day, perhaps, she will make a loaf that comes out flat and heavy, and she will turn the card over, looking for the answer. I hope she finds a note in my handwriting that says, quite simply, "keep watching".

Word notes

yeast　イースト（パンをふくらませる酵母）

Questions

Q1 In paragraph ②, what did the writer believe when her grandmother refused to give exact amounts?

(A) Her grandmother wanted her to buy a cookbook instead.

(B) Her grandmother thought she was too young to use the oven.

(C) Her grandmother was teasing her or had lost the real figures.

(D) Her grandmother kept the numbers on cards hidden in another box.

Q2 What did aunt Maura tell the writer on the telephone in paragraph ④?

(A) The grandmother judged the dough by touch and changed the amount of flour each day.

(B) The grandmother always used the same weight of flour, written in a secret notebook.

(C) The grandmother never actually baked bread herself.

(D) The grandmother had asked Maura to give the writer the missing numbers.

Q3 Pick the two statements that agree with the passage.

(A) The writer's first attempts at her grandmother's bread were unsuccessful.

(B) The writer believes that recipes with exact numbers are of no value.

(C) The writer kept notes about what she saw, felt and smelled while cooking.

(D) Aunt Maura sent the writer a card with the correct weights written on it.

(E) The writer's niece has already learned to bake bread without any help.

(F) The writer stopped cooking after her second loaf failed.

Q4 In Japanese, explain the writer's point in the underlined part of paragraph ⑤. Use 55 to 65 characters.

Q5 Render the underlined part of paragraph ⑨ in natural Japanese.

II 長文読解（記事）（配点 100点）

Go through the passage, then answer Q1 to Q5.

A Forest the Size of a Tennis Court

① Five years ago, the corner of Linden Street and Harrow Road in the city of Vellmouth was a patch of bare ground where people left broken furniture and shopping trolleys. Today it is covered by a dense thicket* of young oaks, hazels, rowans and wild roses, some already taller than the bus shelter beside them. The whole wood is about the size of a tennis court. Local children call it “the jungle”, and on summer evenings it is loud with birds.

② The wood is one of fourteen “pocket forests” that Vellmouth has planted on unused corners of land since the scheme began. The idea is simple: instead of a few large trees spaced out across a lawn, hundreds of small native* trees and shrubs are planted very close together, three or four to every square metre, on carefully prepared soil. Crowded together, the young plants compete for light and grow upwards quickly. Within a few years, a planting that looked like a field of sticks can become a thick, shady wood.

③ Supporters say pocket forests offer benefits that are out of all proportion to their size. They provide shelter and food for insects and birds, soak up rain that would otherwise run straight into the drains, and cool the air around them on hot days. Volunteers who counted wildlife in the Linden Street wood last summer recorded more than ninety kinds of insect, compared with eleven on a mown grass verge a short walk away.

④ The scheme was the idea of Odile Fenwick, a retired gardener who sits on a residents’ committee. She admits that her first proposal was rejected. “The council said that small woods would be expensive to look after and might attract litter and crime,” she says. “I understood the worry. But the empty corners were already full of litter. A wood, at least, would give people a reason to care.”

⑤ To win support, Fenwick suggested a trial on one site, planted and maintained by volunteers. More than two hundred people turned up on a cold Saturday in November to plant the first wood, many of them families who had never planted a tree before. For the first two years, volunteers watered the saplings* in dry weather and pulled out weeds. After that, the young trees shaded the ground so well that weeds could no longer grow, and the wood began to look after itself.

⑥ Not all residents have been won over. Some say the woods block the view and make streets feel less safe at night. Others complain that the city has chosen the cheapest way to look green without making the bigger changes it really needs, such as fewer cars and more parks. Kiran Osei, who studies urban planning, thinks the second criticism deserves to be taken

seriously. “A pocket forest is a fine thing,” she says. “But treating a few small woods as a substitute for proper green space that everyone can use would be a mistake.”

⑦ Fenwick does not disagree. She points out that the woods were never meant to replace parks, only to make use of land that nobody was using. The committee has also listened to the complaints about safety: newer woods are planted with low shrubs along the pavement, so that people walking past can see over them, and each wood has a path through the middle that is lit at night.

⑧ Perhaps the most striking change has been in how people treat the corners. Fly-tipping*, which used to happen almost every week at Linden Street, has nearly stopped. Neighbours who once hardly spoke now meet at the wood to pick blackberries in autumn. A primary school nearby uses it for science lessons, and pupils keep a diary of the birds they see.

⑨ Researchers caution that pocket forests are still a fairly new idea, and that it is too early to say how they will develop over thirty or forty years. Densely planted trees may need thinning * as they grow, which will cost money. Fenwick is confident that the city will find a way. “People protect what they have planted with their own hands,” she says. “That is worth more than any budget.”

⑩ Last month, the council announced that six more sites would be planted next winter, and, unlike before, it will pay for the soil and the young trees. Fenwick, now seventy-four, plans to be there with a spade. “I will not see these trees fully grown,” she says. “That is not really the point. The children who plant them will.”

Word notes

thicket	茂み，やぶ
native	（その土地に）もとからある，在来の
saplings	苗木
Fly-tipping	ごみの不法投棄
thinning	間引き，間伐

Questions

Q1 For each underlined word below, pick the option from (A) to (D) whose meaning is nearest.

(1) ***rejected*** in paragraph ④

(A) delayed (B) turned down (C) praised (D) copied

(2) ***striking*** in paragraph ⑧

(A) violent (B) tiring (C) noticeable (D) temporary

(3) ***confident*** in paragraph ⑨

(A) sure (B) secret (C) worried (D) careless

(4) ***point*** in paragraph ⑩

(A) sharp end (B) score (C) place (D) purpose

Q2 Render the underlined part of paragraph ⑥ in natural Japanese.

Q3 Mark each statement T if it agrees with the passage and F if it does not.

(A) The trees in a pocket forest are planted far apart so that each one has plenty of light.

(B) More kinds of insect were found in the Linden Street wood than on a nearby grass verge.

(C) Volunteers still have to remove weeds from the first wood every week.

(D) Kiran Osei believes pocket forests should not take the place of real parks.

(E) The city will pay for the soil and young trees for the next six sites.

Q4 The sentence below sums up the passage. Supply one English word for the gap.

Small woods planted on ( ) land can help wildlife and bring neighbours together, but they cannot replace parks.

Q5 Would you like a pocket forest to be planted near your home? Write 55 to 65 English words, giving a reason and an example.

解答用紙　予想問題 第1回

受験番号・氏名欄は省略。記号は (A) のように書く。

I

Q1　［　　］

Q2　［　　］

Q3　［　　］

Q4

80字（20字×4行，10字ごとに太線）

Q5

II

Q1

(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)

Q2

Q3

(A)	(B)	(C)	(D)	(E)

Q4　［　　］

II　Q5（55 to 65 English words）

20語

40語

60語

80語

奥付

予想問題 第1回　英語　問題

対象：山形大学 前期日程 英語（人文社会科学部・医学部ほか 英語を課す学部の共通問題）の受験準備

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作成方法：2024〜2026年度の出題形式・分量・難易度を分析し，英文・設問をすべて新たに書き下ろした。

> **山形大学の過去問・公式問題ではありません。予想問題であり，大学とは関係がありません。**

本冊子の英文は実在の記事・書籍・論文・統計からの引用・翻案ではありません。登場する人物・団体・地名・数値は架空です。無断転載・再配布を禁じます。